



Snapdragon 836 for Pixel 2

The upcoming flagship from Google might possibly be powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon 836 SoC. <http://digit.in/pixel836>



Voice controlled smart ring

The new ORII smart ring is a hands-free bluetooth controller for your smartphone that takes in voice commands. <http://digit.in/ORIInew>

HARRY POTTER - EVERYTHING FROM BRITISH FOLKLORE TO MACBETH

J.K. Rowling has herself admitted to being influenced and inspired by a large number of sources for a wide variety of things in the Harry Potter universe. Starting from British folklore, which she admits to having taken quite a liberty with, she goes on to accept influences from Iliad (saving Cedric's body), Macbeth (The prophecy), The Bible, The Chronicles of Narnia (The entrance to Platform 9 3/4) and more.

Although it is fairly acknowledged that no modern writer of fantasy can escape being compared to Tolkien's Lord of the Rings, the similarities between Harry Potter and LotR are more than superficial. Wormtongue and Wormtail, Shelob and Aragog, Gandalf and Dumbledore, Nazgûl and Dementors, Old Man Willow and the Whomping Willow and the similarities between the



main antagonists, Dark Lord Sauron and Lord Voldemort (the fear around saying their names aloud, both are often referred to as 'The Dark Lord' and are recovering lost power after being considered dead or defeated). Fans of both franchises although generally take it as an honourable nod.

LION KING - KIMBA THE LION

No, that's not a typo. Disney went ahead and heavily borrowed from a Japanese anime from legendary creator Osamu Tezuka, who also created Astro Boy. Yes, Kimba and Simba is a real thing. Early sketches of Lion King even included Simba in white. It doesn't end there – characters like the shaman monkey, the comic relief hyenas and a bird friend are all present in both the anime and the Disney feature.



The antagonist received a sex change treatment, going from Kimba's aunt to Simba's uncle. One of the most iconic scenes from the movie, where Simba talks to the spirit of his father appearing in the cloud, has an almost exact counterpart in Kimba. The sad thing here is if events had occurred the other way round, we doubt that Disney would let it go this easily. To their credit, Simba at least means 'Lion' in Swahili.

G.I.JOE - FURY FORCE (ALSO COBRA - HYDRA)

Rather than drawing a comparison between G.I.Joe and the abandoned Fury Force, it makes more sense to draw a comparison between the antagonists. Both organisations are serpent themed with lackeys that idolise the organisation. Both fight off against semi-government organisations. Too similar to be a coincidence, right? That's because it isn't. Comic book artist Larry Hama was working on an idea for a comic called Fury Force, where Nick Fury's son Fury Jr. would lead an elite S.H.I.E.L.D group against HYDRA.



Source: Pinterest

However, Marvel didn't greenlight the idea back then. But when Hasbro later approached Marvel to write a comic to go with their relaunch of the G.I.Joe series of toys, Marvel brought out the Fury Force concept and rehashed it to fit with the G.I.Joe storyline.

LORD OF THE RINGS - DER RING DES NIBELUNGEN

Yes, we went there. Before hardcore fantasy fans go up in arms against us, check out this study that points out the similarities: <http://digit.in/lotrdrdn>. In fact, Tolkien was so irritated by the comparisons that after the Swedish translator for LotR effectively labelled the two rings as the same, he went on to state "Both rings were round, and there the resemblance ceases".

Both stories have a ring of power, the motifs of the riddle-contest, the cleansing fire, the broken weapon preserved for an heir, and of course the theme of 'the Lord of the Ring as



Scene 1 of Das Rheingold

the slave of the Ring'. Check out this extract from Das Rheingold:

There is one Ring only.

The Ring came by a curse, which is now transferred.

It confers unlimited power on its possessor. Its ownership will now bring no joy, only misery.

It will gradually consume its possessor with anxiety.

It will be sought by all who do not possess it, yet will bring its possessor no contentment.

Its possessor is given the title of Lord of it [...] Possession will be living death and it will bind its possessor even in death: the Lord of the Ring will become its slave.

Keep in mind that these are not cases of plagiarism that have been officially reported or being contested in a court of law. Most of these references are public opinion. Even if extensive reports and analysis exists for some of them, it does not give any of these instances an official acknowledgement of being copied. For that, we might have to wait for a more honest crop of creators. **4**